

A TRUE STORY FROM JUSTIN WELLER

We beat the forecast by 150%.

Then CEO Matt Rizai told us we could have grown faster.

For founders about to add their first sellers.

From his time as a founding salesperson at Workiva.

WHAT MATT RIZAI SAID

“

If you had accurately forecasted that 150% amount, I could have hired more people and we would be growing faster.

MATT RIZAI, WORKIVA CEO

You can crush the number and still hurt growth. The company can’t hire against a forecast it didn’t see coming.

WHY THE FORECAST WAS OFF

Ask the sellers. They'll tell you why.

Required fields pile up.

Nobody maintains them.

Sellers stop updating the system.

"We find the best way with the least effort. … Burden us with requirements that do no real work and we stop updating the system."

JUSTIN WELLER, ON BEING "LAZY EFFICIENT"

THE FIX

The sellers helped build it.

A SALES COUNCIL

A great colleague had the idea. Sellers tell their peers what is hurting progress, then go fix it.

ONE SHEET

Every open deal on one page. A seller with 30 deals open could update the fields that mattered on the spot.

OPEN DEALS	CLOSE	STAGE	AMOUNT	NEXT	CATEGORY
Deal 1					
Deal 2					
Deal 3					
Deal 4					
Deal 5					

THE ONE SHEET

5 Green Fields

- [x] **Close date**
- [x] **Stage**
- [x] **Amount**
- [x] **Next step**
- [x] **Forecast category**
  Commit, Upside, Pipeline

“Get those five right and you should have a pretty damn accurate forecast.”

The hard part: agreeing on what each stage means, then doing it once a week.

FOR FOUNDERS ADDING THEIR FIRST SELLERS

Hold every seller to these five, and your board starts to believe you.

YOUR TURN

Which of the five would your team define differently?

Read the full story
foundersramp.net/writings/five-green-fields